

While the mouse waits, the eyes travel.

Gaze usually reaches a result first; nearby gaze and cursor visits to the same result start close together.

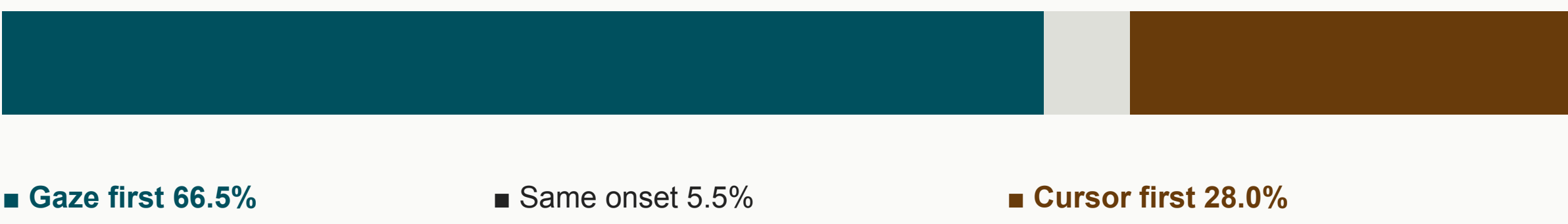
2,650 trials · 47 people choosing a result on search pages with ads · AOI (area of interest) = one result's rectangle · first mousemove to final press

Exploratory timing and sequence analysis

01 FIRST ENTRY TO A RESULT

66.5% gaze arrives first

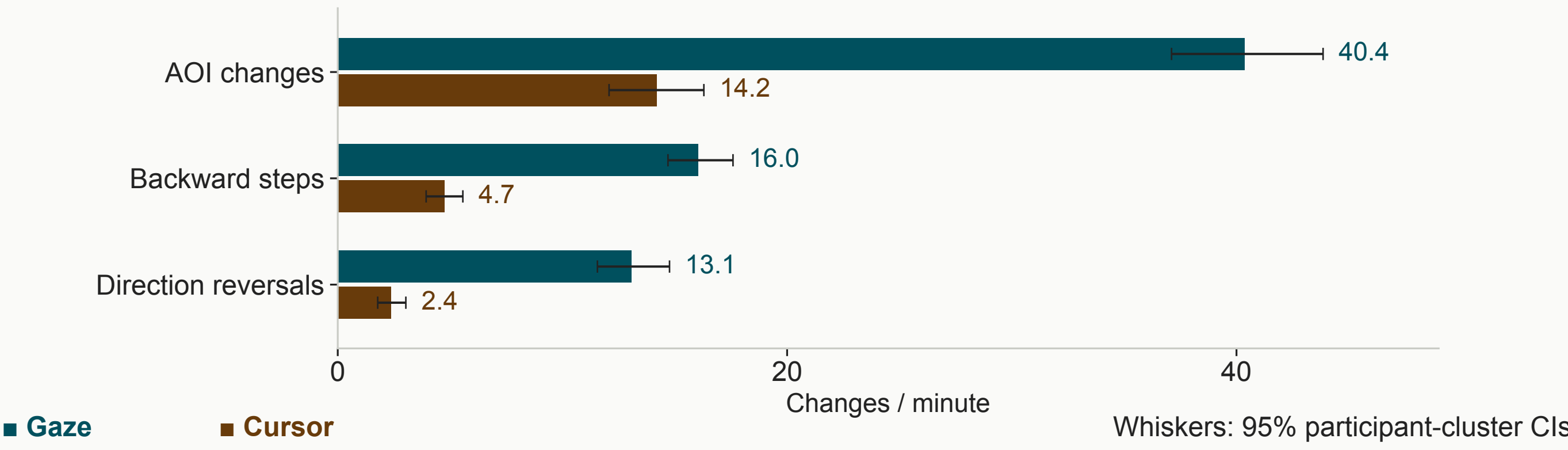
95% CI 63.4–69.4% · 8,175 jointly visited trial–AOIs



Median first-entry difference: cursor 0.94 s later. Ties at the first mousemove count as same onset.

02 THE RECORDED EYE PATH IS BUSIER

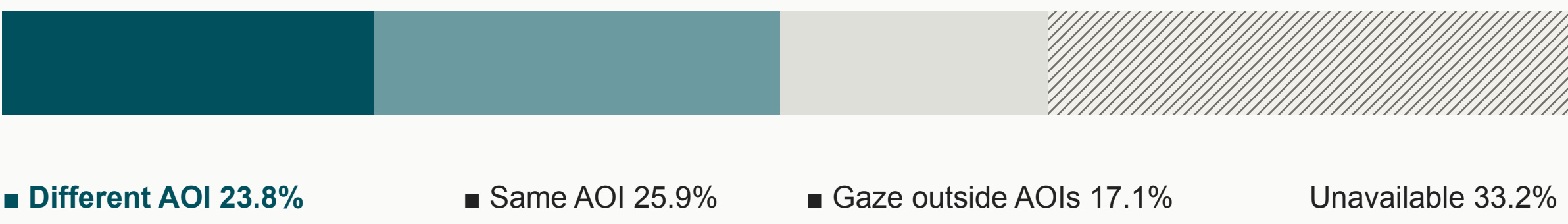
AOI-position changes per minute, over time covered by both signals



03 WHEN THE CURSOR RESTS IN AN AOI

23.8% gaze is on another AOI

95% CI 22.2–25.2% · 57.5 of 242.0 minutes of cursor rest in AOIs

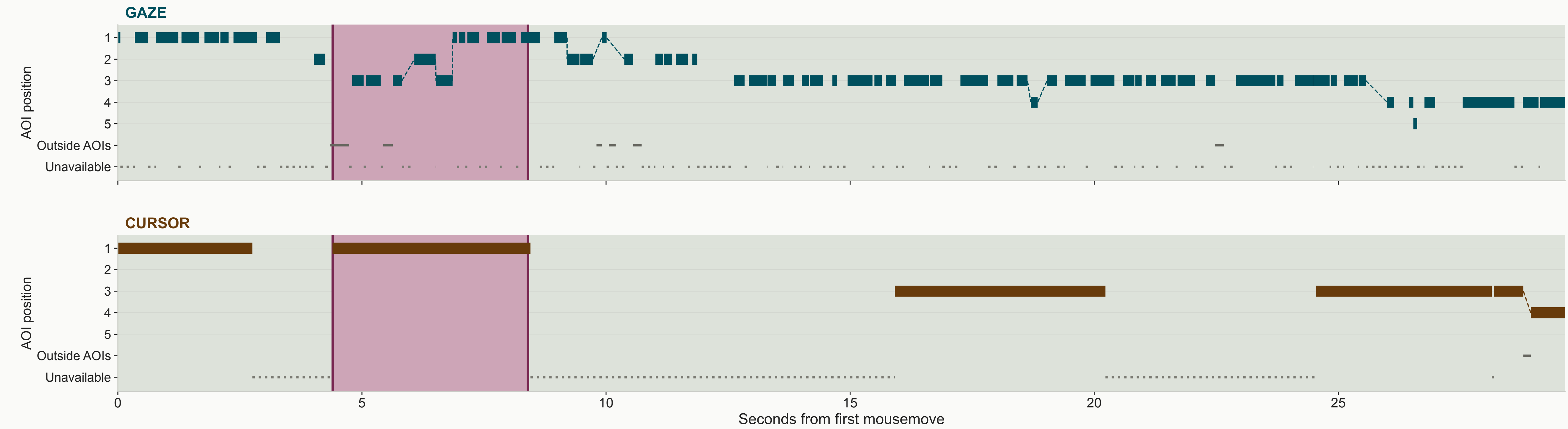


Rest: <50 screenshot px/s, scrolling excluded. Cursor held ≤2 s; held until it next moves: 27.6% [95% CI 25.8–29.1%].

04 ONE OBSERVED TRIAL, TWO PATHS

p021-b1-t6 · 29.65 s from first mousemove to final press · same time and AOI-position scales

Highlight: the same four-second cursor pause →

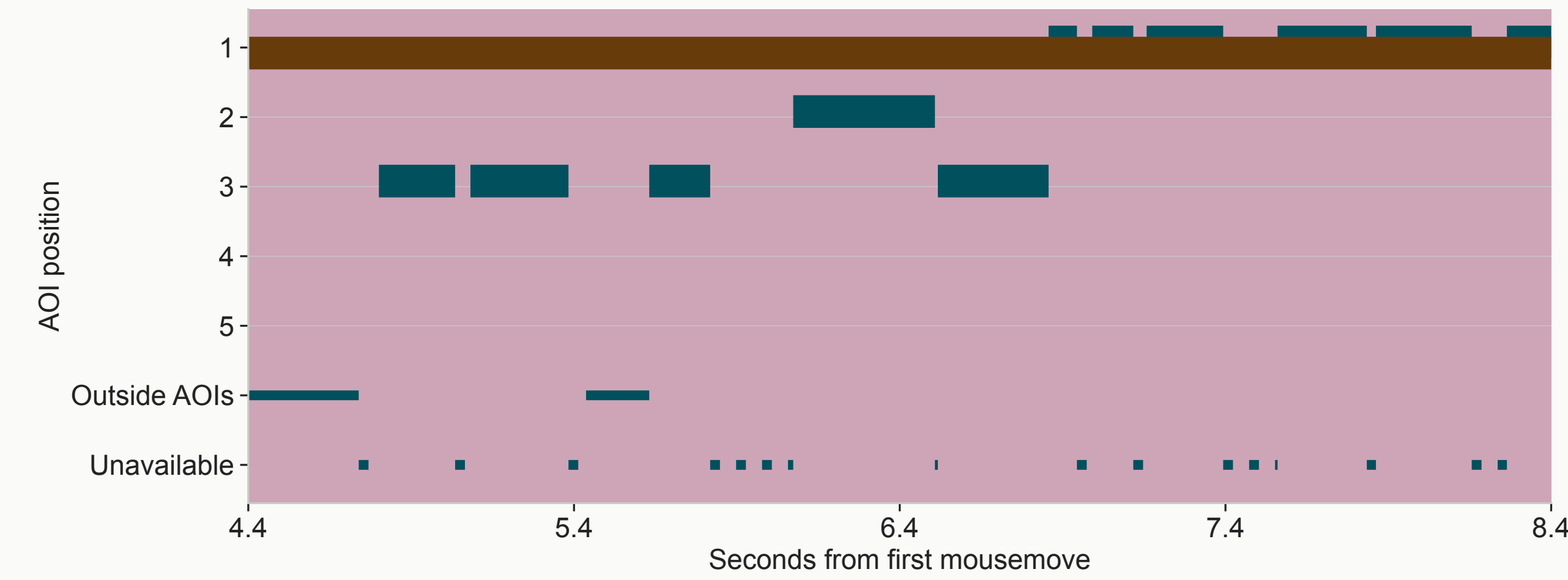


Solid: observed occupancy. Dashed: AOI changes ≤500 ms apart. Unavailable spans sit on the "Unavailable" row.

05 ZOOM INTO THE WAIT

Gaze: 3 → 2 → 3 → 1

Cursor: remains on AOI 1 for 4.0 s



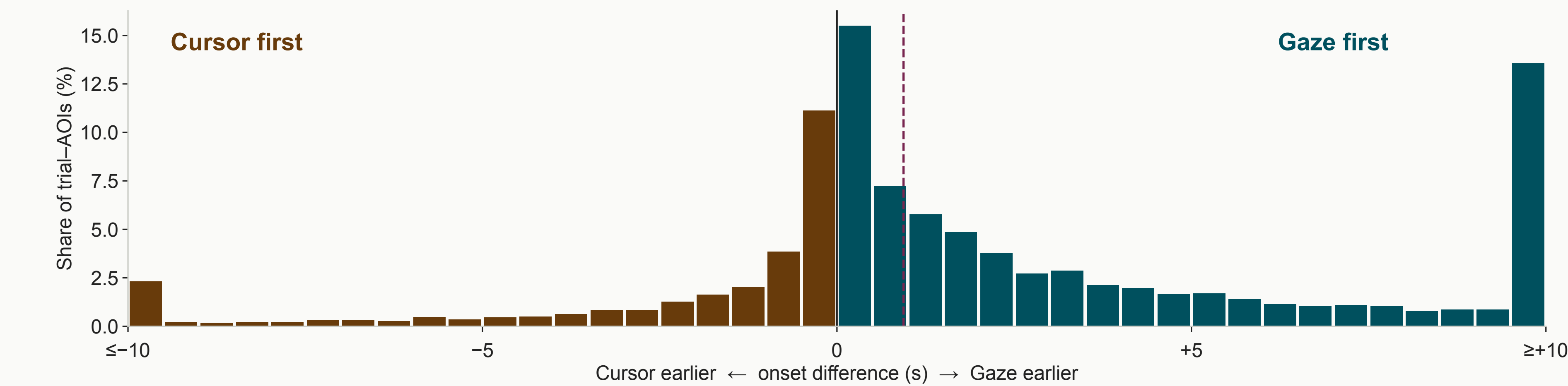
3 gaze AOIs · 1 return · 1.50 s on a different AOI

A fixed rule chose this pause from 63 qualifying pauses of 1,843 lasting 2–8 s; the rule requires a gaze return.

1,225 of those 1,843 pauses include gaze on another AOI.

06 FIRST ARRIVAL: GAZE OFTEN LEADS

Cursor first entry – gaze first entry, for jointly visited AOIs

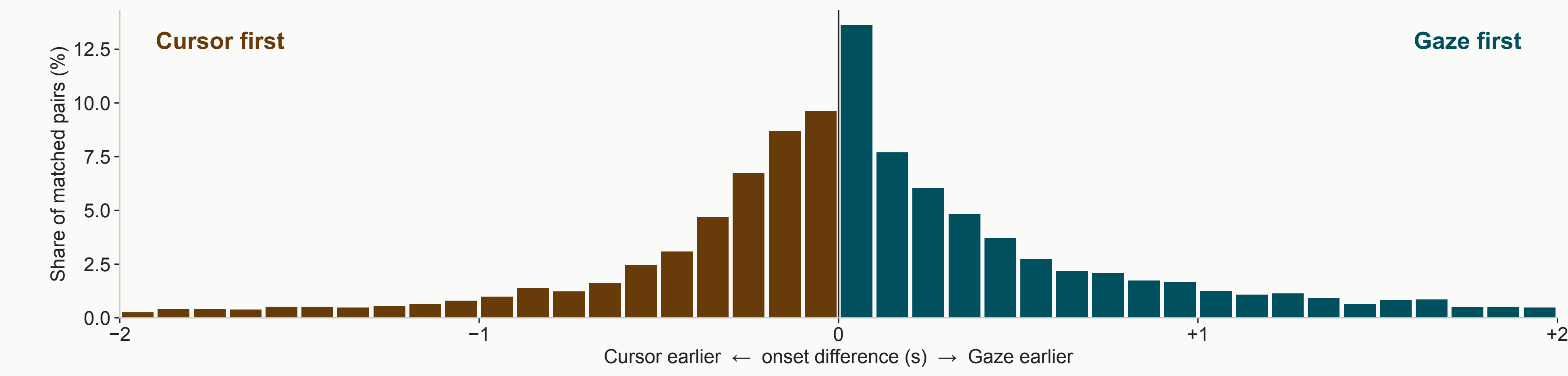


Median +0.939 s · IQR –0.084 to +4.546 s

Outer bars include tails beyond ±10 s. The 0–0.5 s bin includes tied onsets; see panel 01.

07 NEARBY VISITS: LITTLE MEDIAN LAG

One-to-one, same-AOI pairs within ±2 s · 10,321 matched pairs



Median +0.002 s · gaze first 50.1% [95% CI 48.2–51.8%] · ties 4.4%

Without pairs starting at the first mousemove: gaze first 55.3% [95% CI 53.2–57.1%], median +0.049 s. Unmatched: 50,622 gaze, 4,729 cursor visits.